AI IMAGE & VIDEO

20 video effects for Claude

I recorded one take and Claude built all 20 of these effects on top of it. Here they are as 20 free skills, plus the one line that installs them. Each one takes your own talking-head clip and gives you an MP4 back.



START HERE

Install the pack with one line, set up the engine once, then run `/spotlight` on a short clip of yourself. On my Mac mini a 5.5-second clip came back in 19 seconds. That proves the whole chain works before you try the other 19.

1. The one line that installs them

You need Claude Code (Codex works too), plus `ffmpeg`, Node 18 or newer and Python 3. All free. Paste this into Terminal:

Terminal

```
npx skills add charlie947/reel-editing-skills -g -a claude-code -s '*' -y
```

That puts all 41 skills in the pack into `~/.claude/skills/`: the 20 effects, the shared engine they run on, and 20 more editing skills. Keep the `-g`. Without it the skills only go into the folder you are standing in, and the effect cards point at `~/.claude/skills`.

NO NPX? COPY THEM BY HAND

`git clone https://github.com/charlie947/reel-editing-skills.git`, then `cp -R reel-editing-skills/skills/* ~/.claude/skills/`. On Codex, leave out `-a claude-code -y` and pick Codex from the list it shows you.

2. Set up the engine once

All 20 effects run on one shared engine called `video-effects`. It needs a headless Chrome (Puppeteer) to draw the frames, and a free local model (RobustVideoMatting) to cut you out of the shot.

Terminal, once

```
cd ~/.claude/skills/video-effects
npm i puppeteer
python3 -m pip install torch torchvision pillow numpy
```

The cut-out model downloads once from GitHub the first time an effect needs it. It runs on Apple Silicon, an NVIDIA card or the CPU (slow).

THE CHECK

Run `node ~/.claude/skills/video-effects/run.cjs list`. A working install prints 20 numbered lines, from `grid-dive 1.03s` down to `head-pop-out to the end`. Then add `--check` to any effect on your clip. A good result ends with `check passed: spotlight loads and plays from 0.60s on your clip`. If you see `puppeteer not found` instead, the `npm i` step ran in the wrong folder.

This is what the list and the clip check printed on my run:

```
$ node /Users/charlieshermes/renders/fx-page-run/home/.claude/skills/video-effects/run.cjs list
 1  grid-dive          1.03s
 2  title-orbit        1.23s   --words up to 12 characters
 3  magnifying-lens    1.49s
 4  portal             1.02s
 5  clone-room         1.1s
 6  infinite-zoom      1.21s
 7  cube-spin          1.22s
 8  liquid-glass       0.99s
 9  screen-in-screen   1.34s
10  frame-break        2s
11  tile-tunnel        1.06s
12  depth-ui           1.16s   --words up to 60 characters
13  vertigo            1.15s
14  phone-fan          0.98s
15  shatter            1.09s
16  spotlight          1.18s
17  pull-back-reveal   1.31s   --words up to 24 characters
18  ribbon-wrap        1.04s   --words up to 14 characters
19  zoom-through       2.5s   --words up to 60 characters
20  head-pop-out       to the end   --words up to 40 characters
[exit 0]
```

```
$ node /Users/charlieshermes/renders/fx-page-run/home/.claude/skills/video-effects/run.cjs spotlight my-clip.mp4 out/check.mp4 --check
  ⋮
[  28s] frames: 165 (5.50s), fit: scale 1, crop at 1093,0, head found in 5 of 5 samples
note: You fill more of the frame than the effects expect, so you show 1.00x bigger than the reference.
[  31s] needs 0 cut-out frames and 0 stills
check passed: spotlight loads and plays from 0.60s on your clip
[exit 0]
```

3. The first thing to try (about three minutes)

Film 4 to 6 seconds of yourself talking, head and shoulders in shot, with space above your head. Then in Claude Code type `/spotlight` and name the file. Or run it yourself:

Terminal

```
node ~/.claude/skills/video-effects/run.cjs spotlight my-clip.mp4 spotlight.mp4
```

Spotlight is a good first test because it needs no cut-out frames. When that works, run `/head-pop-out`. It is an ending, so it holds to the last frame of your clip. Keep that clip short, because it cuts you out on every frame from the start of the effect.

4. All 20, grouped by the job they do

Every effect plays once, then hands back to your shot. You get a 1080x1920, 30fps H.264 file with your audio kept, the same length as your clip.

Stop the scroll in the first second

Skill	What it does to your clip	Length	Words

/title-orbit	Your words circle your head like a ring, then the camera flies through a letter	1.23s	up to 12
/portal	A ring of blue light opens below your chin and the camera flies through it	1.02s	none
/spotlight	Lights down, one theatre light finds your face, holds, then opens up	1.18s	none
/vertigo	A dolly zoom. You hold your size while a gridded corridor stretches behind you	1.15s	none
/clone-room	Copies of you step out behind you down a corridor, then step back in	1.10s	none

Move between two points

Skill	What it does to your clip	Length	Words
/grid-dive	Pulls back into a wall of tiles, each another moment of your clip, then dives back in	1.03s	none
/infinite-zoom	A frame inside a frame appears beside you, and the camera zooms through both	1.21s	none
/cube-spin	Your shot turns a quarter on a 3D cube and you carry on talking on the side face	1.22s	none
/tile-tunnel	Flies backwards out of your shot down a tunnel of tiles, then back into you	1.06s	none
/shatter	Your shot cracks like glass and the shards fly past, with you whole on the last one	1.09s	none
/liquid-glass	A drop of glass grows into a pill, then a tall pane, and the camera dives through	0.99s	none
/magnifying-lens	A glass lens glides over your chest and magnifies it, then opens out	1.49s	none

Show the screen, the app or the prompt

Skill	What it does to your clip	Length	Words

/screen-in-screen	Pulls back to find your shot playing on a laptop, then dives back into the screen	1.34s	none
/phone-fan	Your shot on a phone, and four more phones fan out behind it like cards	0.98s	none
/pull-back-reveal	Pulls right back to show your shot is the preview in a video editor	1.31s	up to 24
/depth-ui	Your room falls away and app windows float at different depths around you	1.16s	up to 60
/zoom-through	A chat window shows your ask, the reply streams in, and the camera flies into your clip	2.50s	up to 60

Break the frame or end the video

Skill	What it does to your clip	Length	Words
/frame-break	Your shot shrinks into a printed photo while your head stays out over the top edge	2.00s	none
/ribbon-wrap	A blue ribbon with your words wraps round you, a gift tag drops and the camera dives in	1.04s	up to 14
/head-pop-out	Your shot shrinks into a blue panel and your head springs out of the top. Holds to the end	to the end	up to 40

Frame-break and zoom-through need a clip of at least 3 seconds. The rest need 2.

5. The commands, ready to paste

Terminal. Swap my-clip.mp4 for your file

```
# the engine, once per command
E=~/.claude/skills/video-effects/run.cjs

# stop the scroll
node $E title-orbit my-clip.mp4 title-orbit.mp4 --words "BIG NEWS"
node $E portal my-clip.mp4 portal.mp4
node $E spotlight my-clip.mp4 spotlight.mp4
node $E vertigo my-clip.mp4 vertigo.mp4
node $E clone-room my-clip.mp4 clone-room.mp4

# move between two points
node $E grid-dive my-clip.mp4 grid-dive.mp4
node $E infinite-zoom my-clip.mp4 infinite-zoom.mp4
node $E cube-spin my-clip.mp4 cube-spin.mp4
node $E tile-tunnel my-clip.mp4 tile-tunnel.mp4
node $E shatter my-clip.mp4 shatter.mp4
node $E liquid-glass my-clip.mp4 liquid-glass.mp4
node $E magnifying-lens my-clip.mp4 magnifying-lens.mp4

# show the screen, the app or the prompt
node $E screen-in-screen my-clip.mp4 screen-in-screen.mp4
node $E phone-fan my-clip.mp4 phone-fan.mp4
node $E pull-back-reveal my-clip.mp4 pull-back-reveal.mp4 --words "Your clip"
node $E depth-ui my-clip.mp4 depth-ui.mp4 --words "Add a depth effect to my video"
node $E zoom-through my-clip.mp4 zoom-through.mp4 --words "Add a zoom-through to my
video"

# break the frame or end the video
node $E frame-break my-clip.mp4 frame-break.mp4
node $E ribbon-wrap my-clip.mp4 ribbon-wrap.mp4 --words "NEW LAUNCH"
node $E head-pop-out my-clip.mp4 head-pop-out.mp4 --words "New video every Monday"
```

The options every effect takes

Option	What it does
`--at 1.2`	When the effect starts, in seconds. Default 0.6s, earlier on a short clip
`--len 1.5`	How long it plays. Each effect has its own default (the Length column above)
`--words "..."`	The words it shows, for the six effects with a Words limit. Longer text is cut

`--from 4 --to 9`	Use only this part of your clip
`--stage blue`	The studio colour behind you: white (default), blue or grey
`--no-fit`	Keep your own framing. By default your head is scaled and centred where the effects expect it
`--check`	Fit and load the effect only, no render. Takes seconds
`--keep`	Keep the work files in a folder beside the output

6. Three ways I would use them

01 **A hook in the first second.** Put `/title-orbit` with your two-word topic at `--at 0.3` on the opening of a reel.

02 **A turn between two points.** Cut your take where the second point starts, and run `/cube-spin` or `/grid-dive` on that part with `--from` and `--to`.

03 **An ending.** Run `/head-pop-out` on the last 3 seconds with your call to action in `--words`.

One effect per beat is plenty. Do not stack all 20 in one video.

7. When something does not work

What you see	What it means	The fix
`puppeteer not found`	The engine cannot find Chrome	Run `npm i puppeteer` inside `~/.claude/skills/video-effects`
`No module named 'torch'`	The cut-out model has nothing to run on	`python3 -m pip install torch torchvision pillow numpy`
`Cannot find module .../run.cjs`	You installed without `-g`, so the pack sits in one project folder	Re-run the install line with `-g`

`the effect needs 1.2s from 0.6s, but the clip is 1.50s`	Your clip is too short for that effect	Use a longer clip or a smaller `--at`
`warning: your clip is HDR`	iPhone HDR footage. The colours come out washed out	Export the clip as SDR (Rec.709) first
`note: There is little room above your head...`	Your head sits near the top or the edge of the frame, so the effects sit off target	Film with space above your head
Your face doubled or missing mid-effect	The fit or the cut-out missed	Pull a still from the middle of the effect and check it before you post. Try `--no-fit`
It is slow	Cutting you out is the slow part. Each effect took 17 to 39 seconds on my Mac mini	Keep clips short. Use `--from` and `--to`

WHAT YOU GET, HONESTLY

I ran all 20 on one 5.5-second clip of me, and every one finished. On your clip, each effect plays once at full size and hands back to your shot. These skills get you the effects. They do not cut your take, add captions or mix music. The other 20 skills in the pack do those jobs.

Next steps

01 Paste the install line, then the three setup lines. Run `list` and see 20 lines.

02 Film 5 seconds of yourself and run `/spotlight`. Watch it all the way through.

03 Pick one effect per group and put it in your next reel: a hook, a turn, an ending.

Credit

The pack is my own work, MIT licensed. The cut-out of you comes from RobustVideoMatting (Peter Lin and others), which is GPL-3.0 licensed. It is downloaded on first use and is not bundled in the pack.

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